Novel Prep English Diagnostic Assessment

Grades 7–8 · Reading, Language & Writing · 100 points

Name:		Date:	
Grade:		School:	
Start time:		Finish time:	

Test Overview

Part	Questions	Points	Suggested time
I. Reading	1–9 (4 pts each)	36	15 minutes
II. Language	10–31 (2 pts each)	44	15 minutes
III. Writing	1 essay	20	20 minutes
Total	31 + essay	**100**	About 50-60 minutes

Directions

- Reading questions are worth 4 points each. Language questions are worth 2 points each. Circle the letter of the best answer.
- Read each passage carefully. You may underline and take notes on the passages.
- Write the time when you start and finish each passage in the spaces provided.
- Answer every question. There is no penalty for guessing.
- Do not use a dictionary, phone, translator, or AI tool.

Part I · Reading

9 questions × 4 points = 36 points. Read each passage, then answer the questions that follow.

Passage 1 *Informational Text: Science*

> Solar energy is energy that comes from the sun. Scientists call this a renewable resource because the sun will keep producing energy for billions of years. In contrast, coal and oil are non-renewable, which means they can run out one day.
>
> Many schools now use solar panels to get electricity. The primary benefit of using solar energy is that it does not hurt the environment. However, there is one challenge: solar panels cannot collect energy at night or on cloudy days. Therefore, some buildings use batteries to store the extra energy for later use.

1. What is the main idea of this passage?

- **A.** Solar energy is useful, but it has some limits.
- **B.** Coal and oil are formed deep underground.
- **C.** Solar panels are easy to build and install.
- **D.** The sun produces a great amount of heat.

2. According to the passage, why is solar energy called “renewable”?

- **A.** It costs a lot of money to use.
- **B.** It works best on cloudy days.
- **C.** The sun will keep producing energy.
- **D.** It can harm the environment.

3. What does the word **benefit** mean in the second paragraph?

- **A.** a problem
- **B.** a cost
- **C.** a rule
- **D.** an advantage

Passage 2 *Biography: Andrew Carnegie*

1 In the 1800s a man named Andrew Carnegie helped build the United States steel industry, making him the wealthiest person of his time. His beginnings, though, were much humbler.

2 Born in Scotland in 1835, Carnegie was the son of a weaver. Twelve years later, his father was out of work when his profession became obsolete due to the invention of machines that could do what had previously been done by hand. "I began to learn what poverty meant," Carnegie later wrote. "And then and there came the resolve that I would cure that when I became a man." The financial successes he would ultimately achieve in his career fully supported this claim.

3 In 1848, at age 13, Carnegie moved with his family to Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania, in the United States, hopeful that the opportunities of a new land would bring the financial stability they had been unable to secure in Scotland.

4 Soon after, Carnegie got a job as a messenger boy for the city's telegraph office. He frequently had to deliver messages to the theater; he saved those deliveries for the evening so that he could then stay and watch the plays by Shakespeare and other great playwrights. When he was not working, Carnegie enjoyed spending much of his free time at a small local library.

5 In 1853 Carnegie took a job as the personal assistant to the superintendent of the Pennsylvania Railroad's western division. Always enthusiastic to accept new challenges, Carnegie eventually became superintendent himself. Throughout the 1860s, Carnegie continued to accumulate wealth.

6 In 1868, at age 33, Carnegie wrote a letter to himself, in which he vowed to retire from business two years later and live on a fixed income. He would give the rest of his money to humanitarian causes and spend most of his time "receiving instruction" and "reading systematically," he wrote.

7 While Carnegie's intentions may have been pure, his actions did little to support those intentions. Just a few years later in 1872, as the railroad industry was thriving, Carnegie realized that steel railroad tracks were the future. He decided to invest heavily in steel after learning about a new process that made it easier, faster, and cheaper to convert iron to steel. Carnegie opened his first steel plant in 1875, and his business expanded over the remainder of the century. In this period, Carnegie ingeniously built the Carnegie Steel empire.

8 In 1901 Carnegie decided that he would rather spend more time with his wife and daughter, and he sold his entire steel empire to wealthy financier J.P. Morgan for $480 million. This transaction made Carnegie the richest man in the world at the time.

9 Carnegie was known for saying "The man who dies rich dies disgraced." After his retirement, he used his wealth for a variety of benevolent purposes, such as funding libraries and museums, establishing colleges and schools, and creating a teachers' pension fund. By 1911 he had given away 90 percent of his fortune. Carnegie died in 1919 at age 83.

4. What is the main purpose of the text?

- **A.** to criticize Andrew Carnegie for not giving away enough of his wealth
- **B.** to explain how Andrew Carnegie became a successful businessperson
- **C.** to explore the challenges Andrew Carnegie faced in his career
- **D.** to describe how Andrew Carnegie used steel to build railroads

5. Paragraph 1 describes Carnegie's beginnings as humble. Which idea in paragraph 2 BEST connects to Carnegie's humble beginnings?

- **A.** Carnegie was born in Scotland.
- **B.** Carnegie was born in 1835.
- **C.** Machines replaced work done by hand.
- **D.** Carnegie learned what poverty meant.

6. Which definition BEST fits the meaning of **cure** as it is used in paragraph 2?

- **A.** to make healthy again after an illness
- **B.** to stop by the use of medical treatment
- **C.** to provide a solution for
- **D.** to change something through a chemical process

7. In 1868, why did Carnegie write a letter to himself?

- **A.** to encourage himself to retire early
- **B.** to find a teacher who could help him read
- **C.** to apply for a job at the railroad
- **D.** to choose which causes to donate to

8. Which idea from paragraph 7 BEST reflects the paragraph's main idea?

- **A.** Carnegie realized that steel railroad tracks were the future.
- **B.** Carnegie began building his empire through the steel industry.
- **C.** Carnegie learned about a cheaper way to turn iron into steel.
- **D.** Carnegie opened his first steel plant in the year 1875.

9. Why does the author MOST LIKELY quote Carnegie as saying, "The man who dies rich dies disgraced" in paragraph 9?

- **A.** to emphasize the highly profitable sale of Carnegie's steel empire
- **B.** to identify the motivation for Carnegie's charitable donations
- **C.** to criticize Carnegie for putting money before his family
- **D.** to point out that Carnegie died the richest man in the world

Part II · Language

22 questions × 2 points = 44 points. Choose the best answer. "NO CHANGE" means the original wording is best.

10. Which sentence is compound?

- **A.** After dinner, we washed the dishes.
- **B.** We washed the dishes after we ate dinner.
- **C.** We ate dinner, and then we washed the dishes.
- **D.** Washing the dishes after dinner is a family rule.

11. Which is **NOT** a complete sentence?

- **A.** The dog next door, which barks all night.
- **B.** The dog next door barks all night.
- **C.** Stop.
- **D.** Although the dog barks, we sleep well.

12. *There is many reasons to join the club.* What is the best revision?

- **A.** NO CHANGE
- **B.** There be many reasons
- **C.** There are many reasons
- **D.** There's many reasons

13. Which sentence contains an agreement error?

- **A.** The teacher, along with her students, are going on the trip.
- **B.** The team is traveling by bus.
- **C.** Some of the water has leaked.
- **D.** Mathematics is my favorite subject.

14. The coach insists that every player _____ water during practice.

- **A.** drink
- **B.** drank
- **C.** drinks
- **D.** is drinking

15. The award was given to Rachel and _____.

- **A.** I
- **B.** myself
- **C.** mine
- **D.** me

16. *If a student forgets his or her ID, you must get a pass from the office.* What is the best revision?

- **A.** NO CHANGE
- **B.** he or she must get a pass
- **C.** a student's pass must be gotten
- **D.** one must get your pass

17. *She did good on the science test.* What is the best revision?

A. NO CHANGE
B. did goodly
C. did well
D. did better than

18. Of the two paintings, this one is _____.

A. most colorful
B. more colorfuller
C. colorfulest
D. more colorful

19. *After finishing the marathon, a huge meal was all Diego wanted.* What is the best revision?

A. NO CHANGE
B. A huge meal, after finishing the marathon, was Diego's wish.
C. After finishing the marathon, Diego's only wish was a huge meal.
D. After finishing the marathon, Diego wanted only a huge meal.

20. The teacher asked us to read the chapter, answer the questions, and _____.

A. we should write a summary
B. write a summary
C. writing a summary
D. a summary written

21. *Not only did the storm knock down trees, but it also flooding the streets.* What is the best revision?

A. NO CHANGE
B. and the streets were also flooded by it
C. but also the streets flooding
D. but it also flooded the streets

22. *You finished the reading didn't you?* What is the best revision?

A. NO CHANGE
B. reading, didn't you?
C. reading didn't, you?
D. reading; didn't you?

23. *I wanted to go to the concert but I had too much homework.* What is the best revision?

A. NO CHANGE
B. concert, but I had
C. concert but, I had
D. concert; but, I had

24. *My best friend Jada who lives next door plays the drums.* (The writer has one best friend.) What is the best revision?

A. NO CHANGE
B. My best friend Jada, who lives next door plays
C. My best friend, Jada, who lives next door, plays
D. My best friend, Jada who lives next door, plays

25. All ten _____ locker rooms were freshly painted.

- **A.** players
- **B.** player's
- **C.** players's
- **D.** players'

26. _____ going to the library after school?

- **A.** Whose
- **B.** Whos
- **C.** Who's
- **D.** Who'se

27. Which sentence uses an apostrophe **incorrectly**?

- **A.** We bought three new lamp's.
- **B.** The children's toys were everywhere.
- **C.** She's my best friend.
- **D.** The boss's office is upstairs.

28. "*If we leave now,*" *Sam said,* "*We can still catch the bus.*" What is the best revision?

- **A.** NO CHANGE
- **B.** said, "we can still catch the bus."
- **C.** said. "we can still catch the bus."
- **D.** said "We can still catch the bus."

29. Which title is punctuated correctly?

- **A.** We read the short story, "The Lottery." in class.
- **B.** We read the short story The Lottery in "class."
- **C.** We read the short story 'The Lottery,' in class.
- **D.** We read the short story "The Lottery" in class.

30. Choose the best word or words to join the thoughts together. *I love summer.* _____ *I love swimming at the beach in July.*

- **A.** Therefore,
- **B.** However,
- **C.** For example,
- **D.** Nevertheless,

31. Choose the best word or words to join the thoughts together. *She practiced every day;* _____ *her skills improved quickly.*

- **A.** therefore,
- **B.** however,
- **C.** for example,
- **D.** nevertheless,

Part III · Writing

*20 points · 20 minutes · Choose **ONE** option. Circle the option you chose.*

Option A · Personal Experience

> Everyone faces moments that are hard: a difficult class, a new school, a tough game, or a problem with a friend.

Prompt: *Write about a time you faced a challenge. Describe what happened, how you felt, what you did, and what you learned from the experience.*

Option B · Argument

> Some people believe homework helps students practice and build good habits. Others believe it causes stress and takes time away from family, sleep, and activities.

Prompt: *Should middle school students have homework every night? State your opinion and support it with reasons and examples. Explain why the other side is less convincing.*

Your writing will be scored on:

Criterion	Points	Option A: Personal Experience	Option B: Argument
Focus	4	One clear event with a clear point	A clear opinion that answers the question
Development	6	Specific details, actions, feelings, dialogue	2–3 reasons, each with an example
Reflection / Other side	4	Explains what you learned or how you changed	Explains why the other side is weaker
Organization	3	Clear beginning, middle, and end	Introduction, body, and conclusion
Language & Conventions	3	Varied sentences, few errors	Varied sentences, few errors

Aim for 3–5 paragraphs (about 200–300 words).

My Writing

End of test. Check your answers if you have time left.